

Phone use evolves

The smartphone experience hasn't changed since the first iPhone. Meanwhile, our reliance on the smartphone has changed drastically. AI should take away the mental bandwidth of things you don't need to think about, and this will start happening from 2026 onwards. What if AI rewrites the fundamental interaction layer itself? These aren't traditional apps you



launch, they appear when you need them. It won't be one operating system for a billion users, it will be a billion operating systems for a billion users. The smartphone will remain the main gateway, because it has unmatched access to user context. But the experience will move fluidly from audio to smartwatch to glasses. It won't be a sole reliance on the phone.

—AKIS EVANGELIDIS, CO-FOUNDER & PRESIDENT, INDIA, NOTHING

Newer data for AI

By 2026, we'll reach peak value from publicly available data, as AI models extract the last drops of signal from the open internet. The next wave of AI progress will depend as much on discovering untapped data as refining algorithms. Organisations will turn inward, racing to unlock data trapped in legacy systems; though privacy and governance hurdles will slow progress.

Synthetic data will emerge as a critical enabler, offering scalable ways to train and test models without exposing sensitive information. Financial services will lead in simulations and risk modelling, as other regulated sectors tread carefully in India.

—SUDHARSAN ARAVAMUTHAN, HEAD OF ENGINEERING, PURE STORAGE



AI-led hiring

Our data show that 71% of Indian workers are already leveraging AI not just for tasks, but to help them plan their next career move or validate their ideas. We're moving toward 'Discovery-led Hiring,' where AI doesn't just wait for you to find a job; it helps you discover a career you didn't even know you were qualified for. In the coming year, AI agents won't just wait for you to type a keyword. They'll act like a coach who knows your skills and your potential better than a traditional resume ever could. AI will handle the heavy lifting, allowing people to focus on decisions that require experience and empathy.

—SASHI KUMAR, MANAGING DIRECTOR, INDEED INDIA



AI-powered threats to rise

AI will empower both attackers and defenders. What's changing is not just that attackers are using AI, but how fast and adaptive attacks are becoming. We're already seeing phishing, malware, and social-engineering attempts that learn, adjust, and scale almost on their own. That fundamentally raises the bar for defenders — traditional tools and

manual processes simply won't keep up. It will be the use of self-driven and AI-powered threat detection and reaction solutions that run around the clock in distributed cloud and edge setups. This means automation is no longer a choice but an essential need of the hour. It's about systems that think ahead, adapt, and help users make safer decisions without causing friction.

—RAJESH CHHABRA, GENERAL MANAGER, INDIA & SOUTH ASIA, ACRONIS

